SpeechGeek



Season Eight: Winter 2011

SpeechGeek

ISSN 1545-9209 Price $25 US
http://www.speechgeek.com

Season Eight: Winter 2011

SpeechGeek
ISSN 1545-9209

Corey Alderdice
Editor and Publisher

Email:
thegeek@speechgeek.com

806 Brownstone Way
Bowling Green, KY 42104
(270) 705-3632

SpeechGeek is published four times per year: August, October, December, and April by Corey Alderdice, 806 Brownstone Way, Bowling Green, Kentucky 42104. Special issues are published from time to time.

http://www.speechgeek.com

The Geek and Mrs. Geek have had a busy two months since the release of our Season Eight: Fall 2010 issue.

You see, we welcomed the newest forensicator to our family: Elliott. He may only be eight weeks old, but it seems that he already has the booming voice and screaming of a future Dramatic Interp all-star.

Based on the way I smile when I see him, maybe he'd be better suited for H.I. rounds?

Maybe he won't even like forensics--though I highly doubt that.

While every season is a new adventure, this one has been even more so around the SpeechGeek HQ. Becuase of our new addition, this second issue wraps Season Eight.

Don't worry, though, as there's still a lot of great stuff in store for you before Nationals 2011 in Dallas!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

Don't forget to become a fan of **SpeechGeek** on Facebook at: **facebook.com/speechgeek**.

SpeechGeek

In This Issue:
Season Eight: Winter 2011

Duo Interpretation (Male/Male)
Hypothetically Yours
by Katie Newport.....04

Duo Interpretation (Male/Female)
Chasing Snowflakes
by Katie Newport.....10

Humorous Interpretation
How to do Nothing Successfully
by Clint Snyder.....18

Dramatic Interpretation
For My Baby
by Beatrice Pickens.....20

Humorous Interpretation
Reggie Wilson: Boy Detective
by Christopher Rife.....24

Hypothetically Yours

by Katie Newport

(Brian knocks on door, and Jeremy answers it.)

BRIAN. Hey, Jeremy.

JEREMY. Hey, Brian. Linda's not here right now... She should be back in maybe ten, fifteen minutes if you wanted to come back then.

BRIAN. *(lets himself in)* It's fine, I'll just wait here. I needed to talk to you, anyway.

JEREMY. *(closes door after a beat)* Sorry, but I'm actually kind of busy. I've got a lot of--

BRIAN. *(not paying attention)* Jeremy, can I ask you a question?

JEREMY. No.

BRIAN. Because I.... Wait. What?

JEREMY. No, you may not ask me a question.

BRIAN. But... Why not? I really need your help.

JEREMY. I'm sorry, but I cannot allow myself to "help" you again. You know what happened last time.

BRIAN. Oh, come on, Jeremy. We've known each other since high school, before I even started dating your sister. You can't let one little thing-

JEREMY. One little thing? That's a bit of an understatement, don't you think?

BRIAN. You're making this a bigger deal than it needs to be. I mean, that was so long ago that I can barely even remember what happened.

JEREMY. Oh? Let me take you back about two-and-a-half years ago. The location: this very living room.

BRIAN. Jeremy-

JEREMY. I was all dressed up, getting ready for a date. Then you suddenly burst through the door, begging for help and advice.

BRIAN. Are you done now?

JEREMY. *(ignoring him)* Jeremy! I need your help and advice! I want to take Linda to Hawaii for our five-year anniversary—did you know it's been five years since we started dating?--but I can't decide on the best mode of transportation and it is only four months away! Should I buy plane tickets or would a cruise be better?' Then we pro ceeded to go through what could hypothetically happen in each situation.

BRIAN. You can't possibly be blaming that on me.

JEREMY. Long story short, we ended up hypothetically stranded on a hypothetical island where, hypothetically, there was no food. This was, of course, after our hypothetical plane hypothetically crashed due to the hypothetical bird that flew into the hypothetical engine.

BRIAN. Jeremy! That was ages ago. And nothing that bad actually hap pened--

JEREMY. Brian, my date was ticked because I was late to pick her up.

Chasing Snowflakes

by Katie Newport

(It is the one-year anniversary of the first time Michael and Anna met. They are spending it at Anna's apartment, sitting next to each other on her couch. They sit together for a long moment, enjoying each other's presence. She leans her head on his shoulder.)

ANNA. You know what I love?

MICHAEL. (*He glances at her quickly, surprised.)* What's that?

ANNA. (*She stands and walks to the window; he watches her, confused.)* Snow. When it snows, everything just seems so quiet, you know? It's like the whole world is holding its breath, waiting for... something.

MICHAEL. *(He laughs weakly to himself, then looks back at her.)* I know what you mean.

ANNA. Really, though… If anything in this world could be considered magic, it'd be snow.

MICHAEL. *(He frowns in confusion again, but he cannot help but laugh at the dreamy tone in her voice. He stands and walks over to her, wrap ping his arms around her waist.)* Really? Of all the things in the world, you would choose a type of precipitation within the Earth's atmosphere in the form of crystalline water ice as being "magical?"

ANNA. *(She shakes him off, frowning.)* You are such a jerk sometimes. Don't go all science-y on me. You know what I'm talking about.

MICHAEL. I'm not sure that I do.

ANNA. Just look at snowflakes! They're so tiny, but if you really look at them they're… intricate, and beautiful. But all that detail can disappear in an instant and you might not even get a chance to see it.

MICHAEL. *(frowning again)* That sounds more depressing than magical.

ANNA. Oh, come on. It's like… It's like your whole life could change in that instant while you're frozen inside a glittery wonderland. Snow makes wonderful things happen, you just have to watch so you don't miss them.

MICHAEL. I think you're giving it more credit than it deserves.

ANNA. Am I? The first time we met was because of the snow.

MICHAEL. Well, yes.

ANNA. And our first date was during a snowstorm that was almost as bad as this one.

MICHAEL. I suppose you're right, but-

ANNA. *(She looks up at him, grinning.)* Do you remember that? We almost killed ourselves driving to the movie theater.

MICHAEL. (*grinning back at her)* And then by the time we got there, the storm had knocked out the power.

ANNA. *(laughing)* And then we almost killed ourselves driving back to my apartment, chasing snowflakes.

MICHAEL. I have to say, that was probably the best cup of hot chocolate I've had in my life.

ANNA. Exactly! (n*ow acting haughty, but still teasing)* That was a pity date, you know. If it hadn't been for the snow, I might not have gotten to know you well enough to say yes to a second date.

MICHAEL. Are you really going to credit all of that to the snow?

ANNA. Fine, you're right. I didn't like you just because of the snow.

MICHAEL. *(smugly)* Thank you.

ANNA. The hot chocolate helped a lot, too.

MICHAEL. You are hopeless.

ANNA. Hey, in my mind, that date was made perfect by snow, which proves that snow makes wonderful things happen!

MICHAEL. I still don't think you can-

ANNA. And if you don't think that date was wonderful, then you might as well leave.

MICHAEL. *(She was only teasing, but he is hurt by her words.)* I do think those things are wonderful. More than wonderful.

ANNA. As you should.

(*They both laugh, then go to sit back on the couch.)*

ANNA. You're pretty whipped, you know.

MICHAEL. *(He bursts out laughing, offended but knowing that she's not totally wrong.)* Hey, now. Just because I… *(He hesitates, then changes his mind on what he was going to say.)* I don't want to hurt your feelings, doesn't mean that I'm whipped.

ANNA. *(She smirks in response, but does not argue.)*

MICHAEL. *(After a moment, he stands.)* All this talk of hot chocolate—

ANNA. The container of hot chocolate mix is in the third cabinet from the right in the kitchen. The marshmallows should be next to it.

MICHAEL. *(laughing and walking off towards the kitchen)*

ANNA. *(addressing the audience)* You know, I wasn't totally kidding. I only went on that date with him because my friends forced me too and said that he was a pretty good guy. I always wonder what might've happened if we had not bonded over his crazy driving on the icy roads. Or if I would have wanted to go on a second date if all we had done was see a movie and then gone our separate ways, like we had planned. But the snow that day changed my life. My friends were wrong about him; Michael isn't a good guy, he's a great guy. (*laughing)* I know that might sound cheesy but I can't help it. Saying yes to that date might have been the best decision I have made in a long time. I mean, here we are, a year later, still together. *(she pauses, taking a breath)* I've never tried a long-term relation ship before, and it's nice to know that I can. You know? (*She turns back to the scene as he enters.)*

MICHAEL. (*He is carrying two mugs of hot chocolate. He hands one to her, then carefully sits down on the couch with his. He takes a sip, then sets the mug on the coffee table.)* I have to hand it to you; I

wouldn't credit everything that happens to snow, but it definitely does seem to make hot chocolate taste fantastic.

ANNA. (*She takes a sip of her own, then sits down next to him.)* I'm pretty sure it's not the snow that does it.

MICHAEL. (*looking at her in surprise)* Oh? Suddenly you're denying the strength of your all-powerful precipitation?

ANNA. (*She hits his arm lightly, scowling)* I mean, it's not snowflakes that make hot chocolate taste good. My secret recipe for hot chocolate mix makes the hot chocolate taste good.

MICHAEL. So snow has nothing to do with it? Which means that it wasn't because of the snow that our first date went wonderfully? Which means—

ANNA. But of course, if it weren't for the snow, we wouldn't be drinking the hot chocolate.

MICHAEL. *(with an exasperated sigh)* Fine. You win.

ANNA. *(smug once more)* I always do.

MICHAEL. *(After a moment, he takes a deep breath.)* You know what I love?

ANNA. *(She leans her head on his shoulder once more, only kind of paying attention.)* Hmm?

MICHAEL. *(He pauses, then decides to back out.)* Never mind. It was nothing.

ANNA. *(Slightly more interested now, she looks up at him.)* What? What were you going to say?

MICHAEL. (*He pauses once more, unsure of himself.)* It's… you. I love you, Anna.

ANNA. *(She is taken off-guard, and she sits up straight, staring at him. She does not believe that she heard him right.)* What?

MICHAEL. I love you. I have for a while now, and I just didn't know how to say it, or when to say it. I thought that now… with the snow and all… *(He trails off, even less sure of himself. She has stopped looking at him, in shock.)*

ANNA. I… Well… Thank you, I guess.

MICHAEL. *(He looks as though she slapped him.)* Excuse me?

ANNA. I—

MICHAEL. Thank you?!

ANNA. Well, I—

MICHAEL. Thank you? That's all you… (*stopping himself)*

ANNA. Michael, I… I'm sorry, I just… I mean, we've only known each other for a year!

MICHAEL. Don't.

ANNA. Michael, please, I—

MICHAEL. Don't! Don't try and make me feel better. I get it. You don't love me.

ANNA. Stop being so melodramatic! Real life isn't a soap opera, Michael.

MICHAEL. I'm sorry. I didn't realize that I wasn't allowed to be a little upset that the girl I have been dating for a year does not love me.

ANNA. Let's talk about this. It's not that I don't love you, I just…

MICHAEL. What? You just what?

ANNA. I just can't commit to that yet. Love. How can you be so sure that you even love me? Love takes more than a year, Michael!

MICHAEL. No. It doesn't. (*He stands and walks back to the window.)* It's been a whole year, Anna. How are you not sure?

ANNA. I don't know, I… Love is a huge step. I just don't know if we are ready to go there.

MICHAEL. How can you know unless you try?

ANNA. You don't understand. I've never had a boyfriend who I even could consider loving before! I need time to-

MICHAEL. Time? You've had a year, Anna!

ANNA. I know. I'm sorry… I just need to think. You kind of threw this at me, I wasn't expecting…

MICHAEL. *(There is a long pause before he answers, and when he does his voice is soft and sad.)* That's the point of a surprise. You aren't supposed to expect it.

ANNA. Michael, please… *(He doesn't respond.)* Come here, please. *(He freezes, and after a moment she turns to address the audience.)* There's a funny thing about snowflakes. You try to catch them and hold them, to protect them and preserve their beauty. But the tighter you hold them, the faster they melt. The wonderful moment slips from your fingers, shapeless and just… cold. Snowflakes can't last.

MICHAEL. It's snowing pretty hard out. *(His voice is now flat, and she notices.)*

ANNA. Michael, come back. Sit down; we need to talk about this.

MICHAEL. I should go. The roads must already be pretty bad.

ANNA. *(She is growing desperate.)* Michael, stop it!

MICHAEL. What? What should I stop doing, Anna? Should I stop ruining your fantasy world? Your perfect world free of commitments and worries, where no one has to take risks? Where no one has to be willing to depend on another person?

ANNA. No! It's not like that—

MICHAEL. Should I stop loving you?

ANNA. No. Please, no. Just come back over here and—

MICHAEL. Answer this for me, Anna. Do you love me?

ANNA. *(She pauses for a long moment.)* Maybe… I don't know!

MICHAEL. *(He nods to himself, smiling weakly.)* Then I'll go and leave you alone.

ANNA. Wait, please—

MICHAEL. Anna? Call me when you do know. *(He goes to open the door.)*

ANNA. Wait! *(Both freeze, Michael reaching towards the door and Anna reaching towards him. Michael turns to address the audience.)*

MICHAEL. I knew that I was being unfair, but you have to admit, so was she. We could have had a happy ending! All she had to do was stop me. All she had to do was allow herself to let go and stop being afraid of commitment. All she had to do was say—

(*Anna unfreezes and reaches forward, catching his arm and pulling him back into*

The advertisement at the end of this publi

the room.)

ANNA. I love you, too.

MICHAEL. *(He stares at her for a long moment, unsure of whether or not he can believe her.)* Really?

ANNA. (*She nods, smiling a little.)*

MICHAEL. I mean, you're sure?

ANNA. *(She nods again.)* I love you more than snow.
(*His face breaks into a grin and they embrace for a long moment. He tilts his head down to kiss her, but they freeze just before they actually kiss. They stay like that for a moment, both of them with their eyes closed. Slowly, Michael opens his eyes and looks down at her, his expression wistful. He turns to address the audience.)*

MICHAEL. *(He is smiling sadly.)* But, not everyone can have their happy ending. That was all she had to do. And she wanted to; I could see it in her eyes. (*He looks away, closing his eyes for a moment, then looks back, directly at the audience.)* But she didn't.

ANNA. *(She unfreezes, but instead of reaching for him like before, she crosses her arms. Her expression is pained.)* Goodbye, then.

MICHAEL. *(Michael moves back to open the door. He looks over his should at her, an equally pained expression on his face. The next line is uttered softly.)* Goodbye, Anna.

ANNA. *(She turns away from the door, but she does not respond. After a long moment she walks slowly to the window and stares out.)*

MICHAEL. *(Re-entering the scene, addressing the audience but staying off to the side.)* You know, Anna was right. *(He glances back at her for a moment. She is still looking out the window. When he turns back, she slowly makes her way to the couch and lies down.)* Snow transforms the entire world into a glittering wonderland. When I was driving home, the street was so quiet that you could practically hear the snowflakes hit the ground. Everything looked so clean and new. And then, of course, I ruined that, too.

(*He turns to watch Anna as she sits up groggily, rubbing her eyes. She checks the time, and then seems to remember the night before. She rushes to look out the window.)*

ANNA. So much snow… *(As she looks out the window, something seems to catch her eye down the road. She looks more intently, her face worried.)* Police cars… I wonder what…

MICHAEL. *(to the audience)* They had not plowed the roads before I left.

ANNA. *(still looking out the window)* No…

MICHAEL. *(He glances at her, then turns back.)* I made it about four blocks before I lost control of the wheel.

ANNA. *(Barely breathing, she continues looking out the window. She says the next line to herself.)* Just because it's a blue truck out there doesn't mean it's…

MICHAEL. I was distracted, going too fast… Chasing snowflakes.

ANNA. *(whispering]* It can't be him. Please… *(Frantically, she pulls her cell*

cation originally appeared on pages 14-15.

phone out of her pocket. She dials a number and as it rings she walks slowly back to the couch. When no one answers, the phone slips from her hand and she sits down, face blank.)

MICHAEL. Once they found my body, they called my parents. And fairly soon after that, my mom called Anna to tell her… *(As he is talking, Anna reacts to the ringing phone. She reaches for the phone almost reluctantly, and when she answers her eyes are closed.)*

ANNA. Hello?

MICHAEL. But as soon as she heard my mom's voice, she knew.

ANNA. Oh, hello Mrs. Porter. Have you heard from Michael? He hasn't been answering his… *(Her body sagged slightly as she listened to what Michael's mother said on the phone. She bites her lip to keep from sobbing, and the phone slips from her hand once more.)*

MICHAEL. Not everyone can have their happy ending.

ANNA. *(She hugs her knees to her chest, and she's breathing quickly.)* I'm sorry.

MICHAEL. I didn't.

ANNA. I'm so, so sorry.

MICHAEL. But I hope that someday, she will.

ANNA. *(whispering, looking up to the ceiling)* I love you, too.

MICHAEL. She knows how to love. So I know that she will. Someday.

ANNA. I did love you. More than snow.

MICHAEL. *(He smiles slightly, still watching her.)* Yeah. I know.